Unit 11 — Public Speaking and Debate

Track E · Klasse 10 · Niveau E

Learning objectives I

- *I can deliver a 4-minute argued speech with three movements.*
- *I can rebut one specific point and concede one gracefully.*
- *I can listen to a peer's speech and respond with one targeted argument.*

Lead-in I

Maja's class is rehearsing for the school debate society. The motion: *This house would replace one written test per term with a project-based assessment.* The team in favour was, predictably, the one with the project-people. The team against was, less predictably, also the one with one project-person — Mr. Yilmaz had drawn names from a hat.

Reading I

Speech — three movements (extended)

1. **Frame** (45 sec): the motion in your own words + why now.
2. **Argument** (3 min): two points, each with one source / example, plus one anticipated counter and one specific rebuttal.
3. **Close** (15 sec): one sentence + one ask.

Reading II

Plus 30 sec buffer.

Debate signposts (extended)
Opening: *I'd like to argue / The motion before us …* **Listing:** *Firstly … Secondly … Lastly …*
Counter: *My opponent will claim … / However, this misses … / In response, …* **Concession:** *I accept that … but …* **Closing:** *I urge you to support / oppose this motion.*

Practise I

Niveau E — controlled

1. Match phrase to function: *In response* → counter; *I accept that* → concession; *To summarise* → closing.
2. Build a 3-line opening for *for* the motion.

Niveau E — productive

3. Build a 4-minute argued speech outline (bullets) for or against the motion.

Your turn I

Class debate (4 minutes per speaker). Two teams of 4. Each speaker delivers a 4-minute argued speech. Listening team prepares one specific rebuttal per speaker. Moderator times strictly.

Sample

The motion before us is that this house would replace one written test per term with a project-based assessment. I'd like to argue in favour. Firstly, project-based assessment captures skills that a written test cannot — research, design, presentation, and the management of one's own time. The available evidence — including a 2024 OECD review of 18 OECD countries — suggests modest improvements in transferable skill scores when project assessment is added to

Your turn II

the mix. Secondly, project work tends to involve real audiences, which improves the writing. My opponent will claim, fairly, that fairness is harder to police across project formats. I accept that, but a clear marking rubric, agreed in advance, solves the lion's share of that problem. To summarise: replacing one test per term is moderate; the gain is real; the fairness concern is manageable. I urge you to support the motion.

Reflect I

- I can deliver a 4-minute argued speech with three movements.
- I can rebut and concede with specifics.
- I can respond to a peer with a targeted argument.

Further reading / listening I

- ESU (English-Speaking Union) — student debate footage.
- BBC Sounds — *Question Time* extracts.